

This is a copy of a conversation between ChatGPT & Anonymous.

Report conversation

Angular component click accessibility

PR Link: <https://github.com/dotCMS/core/pull/25432>

Conversation Link: <https://chat.openai.com/share/70bfe9b5-7897-4210-ad20-9a2c10e5f0d5>

I am working in an angular component and I am doing this:

```
<li (click)="someMethod($event)">Some Text</li>
```

But I have concern if the accesibility of this, is this accesible?

ChatGPTThe way you've implemented the click event on a list item (li) is not ideal from an accessibility standpoint. Here's why:

Keyboard Accessibility: Click events will not work with keyboard navigation, which is an issue for people who navigate using a keyboard rather than a mouse. An a or button tag automatically comes with keyboard events (like onKeyPress) which are important for accessibility.

Screen Readers: Screen readers expect certain HTML elements to have certain roles. By default, li elements aren't expected to be interactive. This means a screen reader may not communicate to the user that the list item is a clickable control. If you were using a button or a tag, the screen reader would automatically inform the user of its interactivity.

The best way to ensure accessibility is to use the appropriate HTML elements for their intended purpose. If you need a clickable element, use a button or a tag. If you need to style these elements to look different, you can do so using CSS. Here is an example with a button:

Code

If you have a link, then you can do this:

Code

This way, you're making your Angular component more accessible by ensuring that it works for both mouse users and keyboard-only users, and is correctly announced by screen readers.

What about doing this:

```
<li (click)="someMethod($event)" role="button">Some Text</li>
```

ChatGPT Adding `role="button"` does improve the accessibility somewhat by informing assistive technologies like screen readers that the `li` element is acting as a button. However, it still doesn't fully solve the accessibility issue because the element won't be focusable with a keyboard, an important feature for users who navigate with a keyboard rather than a mouse. An element with `role="button"` should be able to receive focus and should handle keyboard input. Buttons are expected to be operable both by pressing Enter and Space keys. To make the `li` element focusable, you could add a `tabindex="0"` attribute:

Code

However, this still doesn't handle the keyboard input. For that, you'd need to add a `keypress` event handler:

Code

But remember, while this may make your `li` behave more like a button, it's still not quite as accessible as using a native button element because it won't have all the built-in accessibility features that a button has. It's usually best to use native HTML elements for their intended purpose wherever possible. In Angular, you would also need to ensure that your `someMethod` event handler can properly handle both click and keydown events. Also note that while the Angular template syntax is case-insensitive, the DOM is not, and as such, the `keydown.space` and `keydown.enter` event bindings should be used for capturing those specific keyboard interactions.